



Grade K Language Arts

OPTIMA ACADEMY ONLINE · FAMILY COURSE OVERVIEW · KINDERGARTEN · FULL YEAR

~12½ hrs per week · 150 min/day, M–F

About this overview. This document is an example of how the course might be taught. This overview is drawn from the Florida course description and Optima's 2026–27 course plan rather than a fully built course, so scholars may see some variation in texts, activities, and projects from course to course, and between the live school and On-Demand. Each teacher also leans into their own strengths and passions; the structure, expectations, and time commitment below are representative of the course as designed.

In Kindergarten Language Arts, young scholars build the foundations of reading, speaking, and writing. The year emphasizes explicit, systematic phonics alongside print awareness, phonological awareness, and the comprehension of stories and informational texts. Through developmentally appropriate activities that blend classical literacy with sound instruction, scholars grow in confidence as they listen, speak, read emergent texts, and express their ideas, discovering the joy of language and communication.

THE YEAR AT A GLANCE

1 Foundational Skills (Phonics & Phonological Awareness) (strand)

Print concepts, alphabet recognition, phonological awareness, grade-level phonics, and reading high-frequency words with automaticity (ELA.K.F).

3 Communication (Writing, Speaking & Conventions) (strand)

Drawing, dictating, and writing narrative, opinion, and informative pieces; oral presentation; grade-level grammar and spelling (ELA.K.C).

5 Expectations: Reasoning & Discussion (foundation)

Citing evidence with support, comprehending grade-level texts, making inferences, and listening respectfully in discussion (ELA.K12.EE).

2 Reading: Prose, Poetry & Informational Texts (strand)

Describing characters, setting, and events; identifying topics and details; retelling; descriptive words; rhyme in poems (ELA.K.R).

4 Vocabulary & Word Knowledge (strand)

Using academic vocabulary, asking about unfamiliar words, and sorting words to build background knowledge (ELA.K.V).

A TYPICAL WEEK

- Daily foundational skills: phonics, phonological awareness, print concepts, and alphabet recognition.
- Reading aloud and shared reading of stories and informational texts, with talk about characters, topics, and details.
- Vocabulary and oral language, building academic words and background knowledge.
- Emergent writing through drawing, dictating, and writing, plus regular practice and check-ins.

TIME COMMITMENT

750 minutes / week

≈ 2½ hours a day, Monday–Friday

- A typical day blends foundational skills, read-alouds and shared reading, oral language, and emergent writing.
- Texts are split roughly 50% literary and 50% informational, as the Florida course expects.
- Scheduled time also supports practice, oral discussion, and regular check-ins.

WHAT SCHOLARS NEED

- Read-aloud and decodable or leveled books (home, library, or school-provided).
- A notebook or writing journal, pencil, and paper.
- A computer with reliable internet and access to Canvas.
- An adult to support read-alouds and emerging readers (especially in Kindergarten).

On-Demand (asynchronous). Scholars move through the course at their own pace, with due dates to keep the year on track. An Optima teacher is available throughout for support, feedback, and grading.

Live school. Live-school scholars take this same course on Optima's VR campus with a teacher and classmates, meeting daily as a core course.